

Heurist DH Database Builder / CMS / Analysis / Visualise / Publish

HeuristNetwork.org

Need to work on your own or as a team?

Don't have dedicated programming staff (or even if you do)?

Need to get moving quickly?

Heurist has a range of functions unequalled by any other Humanities data management system. It places control of database design and publishing squarely in the hands of researchers rather than developers.

Build your database today, not next year! Know that it will work, from the outset!

And if it isn't right to start with, you can change it as much as you like ...

- **Free non-commercial web services:** HeuristRef.net Heurist.Huma-Num.fr (open to all)
- **Open Source:** web service can be installed on a private server (not necessary for most users)
- **Zero installation:** all you need is a standard web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge etc.)
- **No coding:** database creation without technical knowledge (or the need to get a server).
Build a complete, fully-functional, richly linked, searchable database in hours to days
- **Publish as CMS website:** creation in minutes with full control of data visibility and a range of widgets that can be used to build interactive multi-language web sites
- **Incremental development** as needs evolve: modify and extend the database structure at any time without affecting existing data (add new entity types, new relationships, new attributes, new vocabularies and terms, ordering, relabeling etc.)
- **Multi-user, workgroups:** per-record ownership, editing and visibility control organized around workgroups and users, private and public records, hidden fields
- **Centrally maintained:** managed, upgraded and backed up automatically. Archive files can be created and downloaded or pushed to a repository in a few clicks. Databases easily reloaded from an archive file onto a different server.

Structure

- **Restructure on the fly:** database owners can iteratively modify record structure in situ on a live, populated database allowing instant evolution of the structure for new needs
- **Common reusable entity types** (Person, Place, Organisation, Event etc.), template structures for specific fields (archaeology, biography, museums etc.) and ability to publish templates for reuse.
- **Rich field types:** text, memo (long text/html), hierarchical terms/categories, numeric, date/time (including fuzzy/uncertain), geographic objects, file, remote media (image, sound, video, pdf etc.), constrained record links (foreign keys), relationships, personal and workgroup tags
- **Pre-loaded vocabularies & semantic URIs:** DC, BIBO, BIO, DOAP, FOAF, MUSIC, RDF, SKOS, CC licenses, Country codes, Language and many others
- **Multi-value/repeating fields:** order maintained, cardinality (optional/required/limited)
- **Sharing structure:** a central index of databases allows the publication and sharing of structure, allowing time saving and encouragement of data compatibility

Getting data in

- Direct data entry in easily navigated data entry forms built automatically from record definitions, including intuitive referencing of related records and relationships
- CSV import wizard to pull in tabular data /spreadsheets, with normalization of complex multi-entity spreadsheets. This also allows import of data from other databases (SQL dbs, Filemaker, Omeka, Drupal etc.) through record matching and linking
- XML and JSon export/import allowing easy transfer of selected data between databases
- Import of other common formats such as KML, synchronization with Zotero
- Referencing of external files / images in repositories and data services, including IIIF format (consume and serve), streaming sound and videos, 3D models

Getting results

- Simple query builder } simple tree/wizard interface
- Facet query builder } easy navigation of live queries
- Expansion rules builder } drill down into networks of interconnected records
- Combine, save and re-use/publish queries developed with the wizards
- Visualise query results as lists, tables, maps, timelines, networks and custom reports
- Export query results as XML, RDF, CSV, KML, (Geo)JSON, GEPHI, RSS, custom reports etc. as either file-based or through feeds. Restful API.
- Publish multiple CMS websites directly within a database, editable directly within the website and through standard Heurist data entry forms. Easily embed database content - images, audio, video or interface widgets (simple and facet searches, search results, map and timeline, StoryMaps, custom report etc.) in the web site.

Sustainability, archiving, migration

- Centrally maintained for medium to long term sustainability. All Heurist databases and websites will continue to work with little or no work as long as the server is maintained.
- Shared dependency reduces per-database maintenance cost and creates a community of support to sustain the system into the future.
- The French Huma-Num national Humanities data service is helping coordinate (2023/2024) system reviews, improvements and community-building to provide ongoing community-based support for the Heurist system and public servers
- Generates fully self-documenting archivable packages for long-term archiving (text-based metadata and documentation, XML, SQL, CSV/TSV and original file uploads)
- Databases can be quickly regenerated on a new server from the archival package or transferred between databases (even if structures are different) with XML/JSon export/import.

More info: support@HeuristNetwork.org, or simply create a database on the web service (we will send you an introductory email with further information; we don't share your email or bug you).